ENGINEERING / QUICK REFERENCE

VS Code

macOS-default shortcuts for editing, C/C++, Git, build, and debugging

NAVIGATE AND SEARCH

Cmd+Shift+P / F1
Command Palette.

Cmd+P
Quick Open file.

Cmd+Shift+O
Find symbol in current file.

Cmd+T
Find workspace symbol.

Ctrl+G
Go to a line number.

Ctrl+- / Ctrl+Shift+-
Navigate back / forward.

Cmd+Shift+E
Explorer panel.

Cmd+Shift+F
Search workspace.

Cmd+Shift+H
Search/replace workspace.

Cmd+,
Open Settings UI.

Cmd+Shift+X
Extensions panel.

EDITOR AND SELECTION

Cmd+D
Add next occurrence to selection.

Cmd+Shift+L
Select all matching occurrences.

Option+Click
Add another cursor.

Option+Up / Option+Down
Move current line.

Shift+Option+Up / Down
Duplicate line above/below.

Cmd+Shift+K
Delete line.

Cmd+Enter / Cmd+Shift+Enter
Insert line below / above.

Option+Shift+F
Format file (formatter required).

Cmd+/
Toggle line comment.

Shift+Option+A
Toggle block comment.

Cmd+F / Cmd+Option+F
Find / replace within editor.

WINDOWS AND PANELS

Ctrl+‘
Toggle integrated terminal.

Ctrl+Shift+‘
Open new integrated terminal.

Cmd+B
Toggle sidebar.

Cmd+
Split editor.

Cmd+1 / Cmd+2
Focus editor group.

Cmd+W
Close active editor.

Cmd+Shift+M
Open Problems panel.

Cmd+K Cmd+S
Open Keyboard Shortcuts editor.

Cmd+K Z
Enter Zen Mode.

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C / C++ / SYMBOLS

F12 / Option+F12
Go to definition / peek definition.

Shift+F12
Find references.

F2
Rename symbol.

Ctrl+Space
Trigger completions (may conflict with OS).

Cmd+.
Quick fix or code action.

F8 / Shift+F8
Next / previous diagnostic.

Cmd+Shift+B
Run default build task.

Cmd+K Cmd+I
Show hover information.

C/C++ or clangd extension
Required for language intelligence.

CMake Tools extension
Useful for configure/build/test.

RUN AND DEBUG

F5 / Ctrl+F5
Start debugger / run without debugging.

Shift+F5
Stop debugging.

F9
Toggle breakpoint.

F10 / F11 / Shift+F11
Step over / into / out.

Cmd+Shift+D
Run and Debug panel.

.vscode/launch.json
Run/attach configuration.

.vscode/tasks.json
Build or command task definitions.

.vscode/settings.json
Workspace editor configuration.

COMMAND LINE AND GIT

code .
Open current directory (install code CLI first).

code --diff a.c b.c
Open file comparison.

code --wait <file>
Wait until an edited file is closed.

Cmd+Shift+G
Source Control panel.

Git: ... (Command Palette)
Discover Git actions.

File > Save Workspace As
Create .code-workspace file.

KEY CONSIDERATIONS

ON macOS: Cmd is Command; Option is Alt. Windows/Linux use Ctrl for many (not all) shortcuts. Keybindings are configurable and may be overridden by extensions or system-level shortcuts.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION

https://code.visualstudio.com/docs/reference/default-keybindings

https://code.visualstudio.com/docs/configure/keybindings